Univac is an acronym for "Universal Automatic Computer" but I somehow got it into my head, without thinking, that it meant "univac," or "one vacuum tube." From then on, I wrote a series of stories featuring a giant computer I called "Multivac."

The one thing I remember most clearly about that disastrous evening was one of the local races. A Massachusetts Representative, a Democrat, had bucked the landslide and had beaten Henry Cabot Lodge for a seat in the United States Senate. The television set showed him, slim, young, and attractive, thanking his campaign workers with so much charm and grace that I was deeply moved. It was about the only good news that evening, and I said to Gertrude, "What a pity he's Catholic! If he were Protestant he would be the next President of the United States!"

I spoke more prophetically than I knew, for the new Senator was John Fitzgerald Kennedy and he would indeed be the next President of the United States, even though he was a Catholic. Of course, I didn't think to tape-record my remark or to write it down, seal it in an envelope, and put it in a safe. Eight years later, when I reminded Gertrude that I had predicted it, she couldn't remember I had made the remark. And she was my only witness.

Out from Under

On November 8, 1952, I visited Norbert Wiener at his home. I can't find in my diary any indication of how I came to be invited there, and my memory fails me as well. It seems to me that it must have been through his daughter, Margaret (Peggy) Wiener, who was a graduate student in biochemistry at Boston University.

Norbert Wiener was a great mathematician and cybemeticist, certainly the greatest mathematician I have ever come to know personally. He reminded me of Bill Boyd in exaggeration. Norbert was much more brilliant, of course, but also much more peculiar in all the directions in which Bill was peculiar—bumbling, absent-minded, eagerly proud of his accomplishments. Like Bill, of course, he was lovable.

Norbert was humorous-looking—not ugly, but humorous-looking. There was the impulse to smile when you looked at him. He had a rounded abdomen like Santa Claus, a large head with a leonine head of hair, a bulbous nose on which spectacles were precariously perched, and exophthalmic eyes that gave the impression of seeing only vaguely and without detail.

Doubleday was in reasonable raptures over Lucky Starr and the Pirates of the